DISTRICT 201

TOASTMASTERS INTERNATIONAL

Operating Procedures Manual

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https://d201tm.org

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1. PURPOSE AND SCOPE

1.1 Purpose

This Operating Procedures Manual is intended to provide District 201 Officers with a reference source on the operating procedures of the district. It supplements — and does not replace — the governing documents of Toastmasters International, including the District Administrative Bylaws, the Club Constitution, and the Policy and Protocol.

1.2 Scope

The procedures outlined herein are based on requirements of the District 201 Constitution and By-Laws and incorporate the operating practices established by the District Executive Committee and the District Council. These procedures cover:

- District organization and structure
- Officer roles, responsibilities, and qualifications
- Committee charters and procedures
- Meeting conduct and election procedures
- Financial controls and reimbursement
- District awards and recognition
- Speech contests
- Record keeping and communications

1.3 Authority

In the event of any conflict between this document and materials published by Toastmasters International, the Toastmasters International governing documents shall have final authority. District Executive Committee and District Council actions, as recorded in approved minutes, serve as authority for items outside the scope of the District Constitution and By-Laws.

1.4 Revisions

The District Director, with the assistance of the Operations Committee, shall be responsible for periodically reviewing and revising this document for approval by the Executive Committee and the District Council. All changes shall be identified by revision date and authority, and distributed electronically to authorized holders. An official Change Record shall be maintained as an appendix to this manual.

The District Director may perform editorial changes of a purely grammatical nature (spelling, grammar, capitalization, typographic errors) without a council vote. Such changes shall be logged in the Change Record.

1.5 Accessibility

This District 201 Operating Procedures Manual will be permanently available on the District 201 website.

2. DISTRICT ORGANIZATION

2.1 Mission

We build new clubs and support all clubs in achieving excellence.

2.2 District Structure

District 201 is organized into Divisions, each consisting of multiple Areas. Each Area is composed of member clubs. The District Executive Committee provides oversight and direction for all District operations.

2.3 Divisions and Areas

2.3.1 Divisions

The District Council assigns clubs to Divisions at the annual spring council meeting, effective the following July 1. A Division must have a minimum of three Areas. Division assignments shall take into consideration the best interests of clubs and the district.

2.3.2 Areas

Areas shall consist of four to six clubs whenever possible. An area may have three clubs if efforts are made to charter a fourth club. Clubs are assigned based on geographical proximity and club type. The District Director assigns new clubs to existing areas at time of charter or immediately thereafter.

2.4 District Executive Committee (DEC)

Voting members of the District Executive Committee include:

- District Director
- Program Quality Director
- Club Growth Director
- Immediate Past District Director
- Administration Manager
- Finance Manager
- Public Relations Manager
- Division Directors
- Area Directors

The District Executive Committee shall:

1. Meet in person (or virtually) at least four times per year, typically in July, October, January, and April.
2. Review and approve the District Success Plan.
3. Review and approve the district budget to be submitted to World Headquarters by September 30.
4. Oversee the financial operations of the district.

5. Recommend any realignment of clubs into areas and divisions at the annual meeting.
6. Review recommendations and reports of district committees, including the audit committee.
7. Fill any vacancy in an elective office, based on the recommendation of the District Director, subject to approval of the District Council.

2.5 District Council

Voting members of the District Council include the District Executive Committee and the club president and vice president education of each member club in good standing. A club president or vice president education may designate any member of the club to serve as a proxy holder.

The District Council, as the governing body of the district, shall meet at least twice a year (fall and spring) to conduct district business.

2.6 Fully Remote District Leaders

District 201 allows fully remote district leaders to serve in any role. A Fully Remote District Leader is defined as any District Executive Committee member having a registered domicile outside the boundaries of the district in which they serve, and who will not attend onsite events as required by the district. This provision is subject to review by the District Council annually.

3. OFFICERS

3.1 Elected Officers

The elected senior officers of District 201 shall be:

- District Director
- Program Quality Director
- Club Growth Director
- Division Directors (one per Division)

3.2 Appointed Officers

The District Director shall appoint the following officers, subject to approval by the District Executive Committee and confirmation by the District Council:

- Administration Manager
- Finance Manager
- Public Relations Manager
- Area Directors
- District Chief Judge
- District Parliamentarian
- Logistics Manager
- Webmaster
- Other offices as determined by the District Director

Appointees serve at the pleasure of the District Director. Appointed officers are confirmed at the spring conference immediately following the election, or at the following fall conference if appointee information is not yet available.

3.3 Term of Office

All District 201 officers shall serve for one year, beginning July 1 of the program year. The Operations Committee Chair serves on a calendar year basis.

3.4 Vacancies

A vacancy in any elective office shall be filled by the Executive Committee based on the recommendation of the District Director. The individual appointed to fill a vacancy shall meet all qualifications for the role, shall take effect immediately, and shall serve until the next District Council meeting, at which time the appointment is approved or another member is elected.

3.5 Resignation or Removal

Any officer may resign at any time. Any member of the Executive Committee may be removed from office by a two-thirds vote of the Executive Committee. Any appointed officer may be removed by the District Director, effective immediately. A replacement shall be appointed by the same procedure as the original appointment.

3.6 Elected Officer Responsibilities

3.6.1 District Director

- Responsible to the District Council and executes instructions of the TI Board of Directors.
- Presides at all District Council and Executive Committee meetings.
- Establishes district policy, priorities, and direction for the year.
- Authorizes disbursement of funds by the Finance Manager.
- Oversees all reports required by Toastmasters International.
- Oversees Division and Area Director training.
- Presents charters to new clubs.
- Prepares the district calendar and guides the District Success Plan.
- In conjunction with the PQD, CGD, PRM, and FM, develops and monitors the annual budget.
- Awards the District Toastmaster of the Year and other district-level awards.
- Attends the International Convention and Mid-Year Training.

3.6.2 Program Quality Director

- Responsible to the District Council through the District Director.
- Presides in the absence of the District Director.
- Responsible for Division and Area Director training.
- Chairs the Educational and Training/TLI Committee.
- Plans and coordinates all district speech contests.
- Attends the International Convention and Mid-Year Training.

3.6.3 Club Growth Director

- Responsible to the District Council through the District Director.
- Presides in the absence of the District Director and Program Quality Director.
- Develops and implements strategies to build new clubs and retain existing clubs.
- Oversees division, area, and club public relations in conjunction with the Public Relations Manager.
- Chairs and appoints the Club Growth Committee.
- Oversees assignment and training of Club Coaches, Sponsors, and Mentors.
- Attends the International Convention and Mid-Year Training.

3.6.4 Division Director

- Responsible to the District Council through the District Director.
- Carries out all administrative duties assigned by the District Director.
- Arranges and presides over division educational meetings as directed by the PQD.
- Plans, prepares, and conducts division speech contests.

- Assists Area Directors in planning officer training and area speech contests.
- Ensures Area Directors complete and document club visits per TI requirements.
- Attends District Officer Training, District Council meetings, and DEC meetings.
- Awards the Division Toastmaster and Sparkplug of the Year.

3.6.5 Area Director

- Responsible to the District Director through the Division Director.
- Acts as liaison between District and clubs in the area.
- Holds Area Council Meetings at least quarterly.
- Plans, prepares, and conducts area speech contests.
- Promotes inter-club activities within the area.
- Assists clubs with membership renewals, officer lists, and TI proxies.
- Visits each club at least once per six-month period and submits visit reports to TI by established due dates.
- Attends District Officer Training, District Council meetings, and DEC meetings.

3.7 Appointed Officer Responsibilities

3.7.1 Administration Manager

- Responsible to the District Director.
- Custodian of district records, documents, and stationery.
- Keeps minutes of District Council and Executive Committee meetings; publishes on the district website.
- Transmits all records and documents to successor at end of term.

3.7.2 Finance Manager

- Responsible to the District Director.
- Collects and disburses district funds as directed by the District Director.
- Acts as authorized co-signer for the district checking account.
- Maintains district financial records and reports regularly to the District Director.
- Arranges for two audits during the term (mid-year and year-end).

3.7.3 Public Relations Manager

- Responsible to the District Council through the District Director.
- Monitors division, area, and club public relations.
- Chairs the Public Relations Committee.
- Responsible for district public relations and the district communication plan.
- Manages district website, social media, and external communications.

3.7.4 District Chief Judge

- Provides a judging plan and procedure for each district contest.
- Acts as Chief Judge for all district-level contests.

- Secures and trains qualified judges for district contests.
- Ensures all judges meet minimum qualifications (Pathways Level 2 completion minimum).
- Assists areas and divisions in selecting qualified judges.

3.7.5 District Parliamentarian

- Assists the District Director at business meetings to ensure compliance with Roberts Rules of Order and TI Board of Directors Handbook.
- Acts as a resource for clubs, areas, divisions, and district officers on parliamentary procedure.
- Should be, where possible, a member of an official parliamentarian association or thoroughly familiar with parliamentary procedure.

3.7.6 Logistics Manager

- Responsible to the District Director.
- Assists with physical arrangements for all district meetings and events.
- Maintains district physical property for use exclusively in district functions.

3.7.7 Webmaster

- Responsible to the District Director in coordination with the Public Relations Manager.
- Manages and maintains the district website, ensuring content is current, accurate, and accessible.
- Coordinates district calendars, mailings, event registrations, and other electronic communications as directed.
- May manage cloud file storage (e.g., Google Drive, Dropbox) for district documents.
- Works with the Public Relations Manager to ensure brand consistency across all digital platforms.

4. COMMITTEES

All committees shall be provided with copies of applicable policies and procedures to assist them in performing their functions. Committee composition and guidelines may be updated from year to year as needs evolve.

4.1 District Leadership Committee (Nominating)

- Chaired by the Immediate Past District Director, or an active past governor/director in their absence.
- Minimum of two past district governors/directors on the committee.
- Prepares a list of eligible candidates for elective office to be placed in nomination at the annual District Council meeting.
- Evaluates candidates based on written materials and, where appropriate, interviews. Interviews are conducted at minimum when: (a) the position is contested; (b) the position is one of the top three offices; or (c) the committee has reservations about qualifications.
- All candidates who applied in writing are advised of their right to run for any elected position regardless of the nominating committee's recommendation.
- Qualifications based on District Administrative Bylaws, Article VII: Officers.

4.2 Audit Committee

- Appointed by the District Director. Members of the current District Executive Committee may not serve on the current-year audit committee.
- Should comprise at least two past district governors/directors and two members-at-large.
- Meets with the Finance Manager to review financial records for completeness.
- Submits a mid-year audit report to TI by February 15 (covering July 1 to December 31) and a year-end audit report by August 31.
- Presents audit results to the District Executive Committee and District Council.

4.3 Alignment Committee

- Chaired by the Immediate Past District Director, or active past governor/director in their absence.
- Composed of Division Directors or their representatives.
- Prepares club-to-area and area-to-division alignment recommendations for the Executive Committee prior to the annual meeting.
- Alignment becomes effective July 1 following the annual meeting.
- The committee shall strive for no more than four to six clubs per area, and no more than five areas per division.

4.4 Operations (Procedures) Committee

- Chaired by the Immediate Past District Director, or active past governor/director in their absence.
- Minimum of three past district governors/directors and three members-at-large.
- Reviews the Operating Procedures Manual and recommends modifications to the DEC.

- Recommendations are presented to the District Council at the spring conference for acceptance or rejection.
- Publishes all recommended changes on the district website at least 30 days prior to the spring conference.

4.5 Credentials Committee

- Appointed by the District Director; chair should be a past district governor/director where possible.
- Manages the credentials desk at each district council meeting.
- Confirms quorum (one-third of club presidents and VPEs, or their proxies, from member clubs).
- District officers are not counted in the quorum unless they also hold a club officer position or proxy.

4.6 Program Quality (Education & Training) Committee

- Chaired by the Program Quality Director.
- Includes Division Directors, Area Directors, and members appointed by the District Director.
- Promotes educational goals; plans and implements recognition programs for educational achievements.
- Implements training programs; ensures speech contests are conducted per TI rules.
- Plans leadership training for club officers, area directors, and division directors.
- Monitors timely submittal of semiannual dues.

4.7 Club Growth Committee

- Chaired by the Club Growth Director.
- Includes Division Directors, Area Directors, and assistant directors.
- Develops club-building ideas to bring Toastmasters benefits to new demographics.
- Oversees club coaching, sponsoring, mentoring, and new club chartering activities.

4.8 Public Relations Committee

- Chaired by the Public Relations Manager.
- Provides external and internal publicity to enhance the image of Toastmasters International and District 201.
- Manages the district website, social media platforms (Facebook, LinkedIn, Instagram, YouTube, etc.), email accounts, and other media.
- Promotes the Communication and Leadership Award program for community and business leaders.

4.9 Youth Leadership Committee

- Appointed by the District Director.
- Promotes Youth Leadership programs and Speechcraft within the district.

- Coordinates with the Program Quality Director and Club Growth Director on outreach to youth organizations and schools.

4.10 Speakers Bureau

- Appointed by the District Director.
- Organizes and manages the District Speakers Bureau.
- Arranges qualifying speeches and manages membership of the Bureau.
- Schedules qualified speakers at clubs and district events as requested.
- Finds outside speaking venues to promote Toastmasters.

4.11 Historian

- Appointed by the District Director.
- Maintains records of district events including club charters, awards, district elections, and anniversaries.
- Acts as liaison between the district and TI Historical Committee.
- Term overlaps the next historian's term by three months (July 1 to September 30 of the following year) to facilitate continuity.

5. MEETINGS

5.1 District Council Meetings

District Council meetings are held in conjunction with district conferences and are conducted at least twice per year (fall and spring). All proceedings shall follow the current Articles of Incorporation and Bylaws, District Administrative Bylaws, Policies and Protocol of Toastmasters International, and the District 201 Operating Procedures, with Robert's Rules of Order Newly Revised serving as the final parliamentary authority.

5.1.1 Fall Council Meeting Agenda

1. Call to order and flag salute
2. Reading of the district mission
3. Welcome and introductory remarks
4. Credentials committee report and certification of quorum
5. Adoption of standing rules for the meeting
6. Adoption of the meeting agenda
7. Approval of previous meeting minutes
8. Confirmation of appointed officers
9. Review of audit committee report (year-end audit)
10. Approval of district budget
11. Finance Manager's report
12. Reports by District Executive Committee members (District Success Plan, goals, critical success factors)
13. Other committee reports
14. Unfinished business
15. New business
16. Announcements
17. Time and place of next meeting
18. Adjournment

5.1.2 Spring Council Meeting Agenda

1. Call to order and flag salute
2. Reading of the district mission
3. Welcome and introductory remarks
4. Credentials committee report and certification of quorum
5. Adoption of standing rules for the meeting
6. Adoption of the meeting agenda
7. Approval of previous meeting minutes
8. Confirmation of appointed officers for the current year
9. Adoption of procedures committee recommendations
10. Adoption of alignment committee recommendations
11. Nominating committee report
12. Floor nominations and election of district officers

13. Speech by the district director-elect; ratification of appointees
14. Audit committee report (mid-year audit)
15. Finance Manager's report
16. Reports by District Executive Committee members
17. Other committee reports
18. Unfinished business
19. New business
20. Announcements
21. Time and place of next meeting
22. Adjournment

5.2 Meeting Ground Rules and Standing Rules

5.2.1 Quorum

A quorum is defined as **one-third** of the club presidents and vice presidents education (or proxies) from member clubs in the district. District officers are not counted in the quorum unless they also hold a qualifying club position or proxy.

5.2.2 Credentials

Credentials shall be closed at the designated time once a quorum is confirmed. Credentials will not be reopened for late-arriving members unless two-thirds of council members in attendance vote to do so.

5.2.3 Proxy Handling

The district shall send a credential/proxy form to each club president and VPE at least two weeks before any district council meeting. Proxies must be signed by the club president or VPE. Either officer may carry the proxy for both positions. A proxy form template is maintained in the appendices of this manual.

5.2.4 Motions

All major motions not originating from a district standing committee must be presented in writing to the District Director at least 30 days prior to any district council meeting and published in the meeting agenda. The District Director may waive this requirement. Resolutions or motions exceeding 12 words shall be submitted in writing to the District Director before the business meeting begins.

5.2.5 Debate

Debate on any agenda item or motion shall be limited to a maximum of two minutes per speaker. The maximum time for debating any particular motion (including amendments) is 10 minutes, unless two-thirds of council members vote to extend. The Council will vote immediately if the 10-minute limit is reached. No member may speak more than once on the same question until all others wishing to speak have done so.

5.2.6 Candidate Speeches

Each candidate is entitled to a two-minute campaign speech during the election portion of the annual meeting (warning at 1:30, applause at 2:00). In the event there is only one candidate, no speech is required. If a candidate is not present, a seconding speech may be given within the same time limit.

5.2.7 Recognition by the Presiding Officer

Onsite attendees should stand and address the Presiding Officer; wait for acknowledgment; state name, club name and number; then proceed. Online attendees should use the raise-hand feature or chat to request acknowledgment, then state name, club name and number before proceeding.

5.3 District Executive Committee Meetings

The DEC meets at least four times per year, typically in July, October, January, and April. Guests may attend by invitation of the District Director. The DEC receives and evaluates reports from all standing committees and acts on items requiring interim approval between council meetings.

5.4 Submitting Motions

District standing committees (Nominating, Procedures, Alignment, Minutes, Executive, Credentials, Audit, Marketing, and Education & Training) may bring motions directly to the council. All other motions must be submitted in writing at least 30 days in advance of the meeting to be published in the agenda.

6. ELECTIONS AND CAMPAIGNS

6.1 Election Procedures

All district officer elections shall follow Toastmasters International Protocol 9.0 and applicable governing documents. The District Director shall ensure all candidates receive TI procedural rules for campaigns and elections in addition to this manual prior to the election. Elections of district officers are conducted by majority vote at the District Council Annual Meeting, which may be held in person or via approved virtual platform.

6.1.1 Election Application Process

Candidates for elected positions must submit an application to the District Leadership Committee Chair by the published deadline (typically in February). The application package shall include:

1. Candidate Application Form
2. District Leader Biographical Information
3. District Leader Agreement and Release Statement
4. A high-resolution photograph (to be publicly posted on the district website)

The District Leadership Committee must nominate at least one candidate for each of the following positions: District Director, Program Quality Director, and one Division Director per Division. Two candidates must be nominated for Club Growth Director. All candidates for elected positions must attend an interview conducted by the District Leadership Committee.

Members may nominate another qualified member for district leadership by submitting a District Leader Nominating Form to the DLC Chair. Floor nominations are also permitted at the council meeting per Section 6.3 of this manual.

6.2 Campaign Ethics

- All candidate communications and activities shall focus on Toastmasters accomplishments and personal qualifications.
- No negative information about other candidates is permitted in written communications distributed widely or in oral communications at any official Toastmasters event.
- Candidates may distribute campaign materials at area and division contests and may display materials in a designated candidates' corner, provided all candidates have equal access.
- Campaign materials may not be placed on walls, chairs, or tables outside the candidates' corner.

6.3 Floor Nominations

Any member of the district council or their proxy holder who is a member in good standing may make nominations from the floor for any District 201 office, provided the nominee is eligible and has agreed to serve before being placed in nomination.

6.4 Appointment of Appointed Officers

The district director-elect appoints the Administration Manager, Finance Manager, Public Relations Manager, and Area Directors. These appointments are subject to approval by the DEC and confirmation by the District Council at the spring conference, or at the following fall conference if appointee information is not yet available.

7. DISTRICT FINANCES

All financial matters are governed by the District Administrative Bylaws, Article XII, the District Leadership Handbook, and TI Policy and Protocol 8.0 in its entirety.

7.1 Budget

- Each administration shall operate within its budgetary limitations. The district shall maintain a reserve of 25% of projected membership revenue available to the succeeding administration.
- The district budget shall be submitted to World Headquarters by the District Director by September 30 of each year.
- Pre-approval is required for all expenses greater than $500. Pre-approvals shall be signed by the District Director, Program Quality Director, Club Growth Director, and Finance Manager.
- Additional unbudgeted expenses over $500 must be accompanied by a pro forma detailing expected costs and approved by the DEC and/or District Council.

7.2 Expense Authorization

- Any non-budgeted item over $250, or a budgeted item exceeding its budgeted amount by $250 or more, requires prior approval by the District Director.
- Any single expenditure in excess of $500 must be authorized in writing in advance by the District Director and at least one of: Program Quality Director or Club Growth Director, in consultation with the Finance Manager. Advance authorization by email is acceptable.
- Expenses made by the District Director must be authorized in advance by two of the three: Finance Manager, Program Quality Director, and/or Club Growth Director.
- No officer shall sign their own reimbursement check.

7.3 Reimbursement Procedures

- All district personnel with an official budget category may receive reimbursement for expenses incurred when properly submitted with itemized receipts.
- Expense vouchers and claims shall be submitted to the Finance Manager within 60 days of incurring the expense, or by July 31 for expenses incurred in June.
- Two authorized signatures are required on all checks drawn from the district checking account. Authorized signers are: District Director, Finance Manager, Program Quality Director, and Club Growth Director.
- Any expense greater than the pre-approved amount shall be accompanied by a detailed explanation of the variance.

7.4 Travel and Administrative Expenses

- Executive Committee members shall be reimbursed for mileage at the approved Toastmasters International rate for all travel connected with semiannual club visits, staff meetings, area and division director training, DEC meetings, and area/division contests.

- Division Directors, Administration Manager, Finance Manager, and Public Relations Manager may be reimbursed up to $100 for travel within the district related to Toastmasters activities.
- The District Director, Program Quality Director, and Club Growth Director may be reimbursed up to $800 for travel within the district. Coach-rate airfare or mileage (whichever is less) shall be provided for travel to the Annual TI Convention.
- All reimbursements are dependent on available budgetary funds.

7.5 International Convention Expenses

- TI reimburses travel expenses for the District Director, Program Quality Director, Club Growth Director (Key 3) and Immediate Past District Director at rates defined in TI policies.
- Reimbursements cover approved TI hotel, transportation, baggage fees (one bag), and registration. Meals are reimbursed at $30/day with receipts, including travel days.
- The Immediate Past District Director's reimbursement is available only if their year was Distinguished or higher.

7.6 District Events

All division and district educational events (such as fall and spring conferences) are intended to be self-sustaining. Event budgets shall adequately estimate revenue and expenses. Ticket prices shall not be set until all anticipated costs are compiled and a break-even price is calculated. The district retains any profits and absorbs any deficits on budgeted event expenses.

7.7 Audit

- The District Director shall appoint a District Audit Committee by November 1.
- Members of the current DEC may not serve on the current-year audit committee.
- The committee should include at least two past district governors/directors and two members-at-large.
- A mid-year audit report covering July 1 to December 31 shall be submitted to TI by February 15.
- A year-end audit report for the full year shall be submitted to TI by August 31.
- The Audit Committee Chair shall present results to the DEC and District Council.
- Failure to obtain proper authorization for expenditures could result in non-reimbursement.

8. SPEECH CONTESTS

All speech contests shall follow Toastmasters International contest guidelines as described in the TI Speech Contest Rulebook. The Program Quality Director serves as general advisor for all club, area, division, and district contests.

8.1 District-Level Contests

District 201 may hold up to two district contests annually, held in conjunction with the fall and spring conferences:

- Fall/Spring Conference: Humorous Speech Contest
- Fall/Spring Conference: Table Topics Contest (a Tall Tales contest may be substituted at the discretion of the DEC)
- Fall/Spring Conference: Evaluation Contest
- Spring Conference**: International Speech Contest**

8.2 Scheduling

- Area contests shall be scheduled and announced to clubs at least one month prior to the contest. Spring area contests should be scheduled in March.
- Division contests shall be scheduled and announced to areas at least two months prior to the contest. Spring division contests should be scheduled in April.
- Any scheduling exceptions must be approved in advance by the Program Quality Director.

8.3 Contest Awards

The district shall provide trophies for district speech contests. The Speech Contest Chair (appointed by the District Director) shall ensure that trophies and other awards are available. Award certificates, judging forms, and other contest forms are available on the TI website.

8.4 Judge Qualifications

- All judges at area, division, or district contests shall comply with the current TI Speech Contest Rulebook.
- For district contests, judges shall hold at minimum a Pathways Level 2 completion and have previously judged above the club level.
- Judge workshops shall be held each fall and spring prior to the district conference to train judges and to help contestants understand the rules.

8.5 Responsibility

The Speech Contest Chair, appointed by the District Director, ensures contests are conducted per TI contest rules and that judging teams are properly staffed for all area, division, and district conferences.

The Judges Bureau maintains lists of experienced and trained judges and provides judging teams to support community organizations as requested.

9. DISTRICT AWARDS

Award presentations shall follow the guidelines in the TI Toastmasters Leadership Institute. The presenter shall explain why the award is given, the criteria, and why the recipient was selected. All awards presented shall be recorded in the district council meeting minutes.

9.1 Annual "Of the Year" Award Selection

Recipients of the "Of the Year" awards shall be selected by a committee chaired by the Immediate Past District Director (as of July 1). The committee includes the Program Quality Director and Club Growth Director who served during the award year, and may include additional members as the chair deems necessary.

- Area Directors who served in the award year may not serve on the Area Director of the Year selection committee.
- Area Directors and Division Directors who served in the award year may not serve on the Division Director of the Year selection committee.

9.2 Standard Annual Awards

9.2.1 District Toastmaster of the Year

Presented to any member in good standing other than voting DEC members (area director and above). Based on TI Toastmaster of the Year criteria and other criteria as deemed appropriate by the selection committee. Nominations close June 30; the call for nominations is published by May 31.

9.2.2 Club President of the Year

Any club president or any member may submit a nomination. Deadline: June 30; call published by May 31.

9.2.3 Club Vice President Education of the Year

Any VPE or any member may submit a nomination. Deadline: June 30; call published by May 31.

9.2.4 Area Director of the Year

Based on the form in the District Leadership Handbook and other criteria as deemed appropriate. Deadline: June 30.

9.2.5 Division Director of the Year

Based on TI criteria and other criteria as deemed appropriate. Deadline: June 30; call published by May 31.

9.2.6 Inspirational Club of the Year

Awarded to the most inspirational club for exceptional activities during the district year. Deadline: June 30; call published by May 31.

9.2.7 Phoenix Club of the Year

Awarded to the club that most significantly rebounds from low membership and morale. Deadline: June 30; call published by May 31.

9.3 Spark Plug Awards

Any voting member of the DEC may nominate one Spark Plug Award recipient for outstanding performance in their club, area, division, or district. Nominees may not be members of the DEC. Nominations must be submitted in writing to the District Director by the last DEC meeting prior to the spring conference. The top district officers (District Director, PQD, CGD, and IPDD) select no more than ten nominees for recognition at the district conference.

9.4 Other Awards

- Shining Star Award: Individuals who stood out and made a significant difference in the district's mission throughout the year.
- Rising Star Award: Individuals recognized as emerging leaders.
- Communication & Leadership Award: Presented annually to an individual demonstrating outstanding leadership and communication reflecting Toastmasters ideals. Normally awarded to a non-Toastmaster, though Toastmasters may be considered in exceptional circumstances. The recipient must be present at the spring conference.
- Division Director's Choice Award: Presented at the Spring Conference by each Division Director to an individual in their division who went above and beyond in support of the division's mission.
- District Director's Award: Awarded to a Toastmaster of the District Director's choice.

9.5 New Distinguished Toastmasters

Members receiving their DTM designation since the last conference are recognized at the district conference. The Program Quality Director typically presents DTM medallions and badges publicly during a general session, while acknowledging all Distinguished Toastmasters in attendance.

9.6 Distinguished Area and Division Awards

Awards are given to each area and division that reaches the goals set forth in the Distinguished Area and Division Programs by Toastmasters International. These awards are presented by the Immediate Past District Director at the fall conference for the preceding district year.

9.7 Membership and Education Awards

- Membership Awards: Given to clubs achieving outstanding membership gains based on the previous semi-annual renewal.
- Education Awards: Given to clubs with 100% officers trained for the current six-month period.

9.8 Quarterly Awards

The District Director may present quarterly awards to recognize outstanding contributions in the following categories:

- Coach of the Quarter: Selected by the District Trio from among appointed club coaches, based on club progress in the Distinguished Club Program.
- Mentor of the Quarter: Selected by the District Trio from among appointed club mentors.
- Leader of the Pack: Selected by the District Trio based on the number and quality of clubs chartered in the quarter.

9.9 Award Records

Comprehensive lists of all award recipients shall be maintained in the appendices of this manual and updated annually. All records of awards are also included in the district council meeting minutes at the conference where awards are presented.

10. MEMBER AND CLUB INCENTIVE PROGRAMS

District 201 shall establish an annual incentive program to recognize and reward member achievement and club excellence. The Club Growth Director and Program Quality Director shall jointly design incentive programs each year, subject to budget approval by the District Executive Committee. Incentives are funded through the district budget and are dependent on available funds.

10.1 Incentive Program Principles

- Incentives shall be published on the district website at the start of each program year (by August 1).
- All incentives shall have clearly defined eligibility windows, criteria, and deadlines.
- Incentive rewards may include TI Gift Certificates, District Dollars (redeemable for district event registration or district-approved purchases), ribbons, pins, certificates, or other recognition.
- The Club Growth Director is responsible for verifying eligibility and distributing incentive awards.
- Incentive programs shall be reviewed and updated each year to remain relevant and motivating.

10.2 Standard Annual Incentive Categories

The following categories form the standing incentive program framework. Specific deadlines, award values, and eligibility caps are set annually by the Club Growth Director and published on the district website.

10.2.1 Club Officer Training Incentives

- 100% Club Officers Trained — Round 1 (by August 31): All seven officers trained at TLI or a makeup training session. Award: district ribbon and website recognition.
- 100% Club Officers Trained — Round 2 (by February 28/29): Same recognition for clubs completing training in the second round.
- July Challenge (100% by July 31): All seven officers trained AND Club Success Plan submitted by July 31. Award: enhanced incentive (TI Gift Certificate).

10.2.2 Club Success Plan Incentive

- Clubs submitting a completed Club Success Plan — signed by all officers, with copies to their Area Director and Program Quality Director — by the established deadline (typically August 31) receive a TI Gift Certificate.

10.2.3 Membership Building Incentives

- Smedley Award Support: Clubs adding five new, dual, or reinstated members between August 1 and September 30 are supported by the district in earning the TI Smedley Award ribbon.
- Talk Up Toastmasters Support: Clubs adding five new members between January 1 and March 31 are supported in earning the TI Talk Up Toastmasters ribbon, with additional district recognition for top performers.
- Spring Renewal Champion: Clubs achieving or maintaining charter strength (20+ paid members) by March 31 are recognized at the Spring Conference.

- Membership Growth Star: Clubs expanding paid membership by 10% or more over their July 1 base by March 31 receive a Star Award and Spring Conference recognition.
- Open House New Member Incentive: Clubs enrolling new members through a promoted Guest Event (Open House, Homecoming, Reunion, Speechcraft, etc.) receive a per-member district incentive for qualifying clubs, provided the event is communicated to the Club Growth Director in advance and promoted on the district website.

10.2.4 Distinguished Club Program (DCP) Incentives

- Early Distinguished (by March 31): Clubs achieving Distinguished or better early, having submitted a Club Success Plan by August 31, receive a TI Gift Certificate and TI ribbon.
- Excellence in Club Leadership (3 Consecutive Years Distinguished): Clubs achieving Distinguished or better for three consecutive years receive the Club President Award for the president and a district recognition pin for all members.
- Almost Distinguished Certificate: Clubs completing all DCP educational requirements but narrowly missing membership eligibility receive an 'Almost Distinguished' Certificate of Accomplishment.

10.2.5 Education and Pathways Incentives

- Triple Crown Pin: Any District 201 member achieving three or more educational awards within the program year (July 1 to June 30) receives a Toastmasters Triple Crown Pin from the district. Name must appear on the TI Daily Report; one pin per person per year.
- DTM Medallion Award: Any member earning a Pathways or legacy DTM designation within the program year receives a DTM Medallion from the district. DTMs earned before May 1 are presented at the Spring Conference Hall of Fame ceremony; those earned May 1 to June 30 are presented at the annual year-end awards event.
- 100% Pathways Enrollment: Clubs achieving 100% member enrollment in Pathways by a defined deadline receive a TI Gift Certificate.

10.2.6 Club Coach, Mentor, and Sponsor Incentives

- Club Coach Recognition: Coaches whose assigned club achieves Distinguished or better by June 1 are recognized at the Spring Conference and receive a district award.
- New Club Sponsor/Mentor Recognition: Members who sponsor or mentor a newly chartered club receive district recognition at the Spring Conference and a district incentive.
- Speechcraft Superstar: Clubs coordinating a Speechcraft program that recruits new members receive a district incentive, verified by the Club Growth Director.

10.3 District Hall of Fame

District 201 shall maintain a Hall of Fame on the district website, honoring members and clubs for extraordinary contributions. The Hall of Fame shall include:

- Annual award recipients (Toastmaster of the Year, Division Director of the Year, Area Director of the Year, etc.)
- Past District Directors
- Past International Presidents and International Directors from the district
- Presidential Citation recipients
- World Champions of Public Speaking from the district

- Lifetime Achievement and Leadership Legacy Award recipients

The Historian and Administration Manager shall maintain the Hall of Fame in coordination with the Public Relations Manager, updated after each conference.

10.4 Named Lifetime and Legacy Awards

District 201 may establish named lifetime and legacy awards to honor extraordinary long-term contributors. Such awards require approval by the DEC and confirmation by the District Council for inclusion in this manual. Each named award shall include defined eligibility criteria, a selection process, and a record of past recipients in the Hall of Fame.

10.4.1 Lifetime Achievement Award (Roy D. Graham Lifetime Achievement Award)

A Lifetime Achievement Award recognizes a member who has made extraordinary and sustained contributions to the district over a career spanning 10 or more years at the district leadership level, and who has earned the Distinguished Toastmaster (DTM) designation.

- Eligibility: Member in good standing; DTM designation; 10+ years of service in district leadership roles.
- Selection: Committee appointed by the District Director; nominations open to the district; application deadline set annually (typically April 15).
- Presentation: At the annual awards ceremony or Spring Conference.

10.4.2 Leadership Legacy Award (Lydia Boyd Leadership Legacy Award)

A Leadership Legacy Award honors a member who demonstrates outstanding leadership, effective communication, impactful mentorship, and meaningful recognition of others — inspiring peers through dedication and unwavering commitment to excellence.

- Eligibility: Active membership in a District 201 club in good standing; served at least 6 months as a club officer or higher; significant contributions in at least four roles beyond the club level that advance district success.
- Selection: Committee appointed by the District Director; nominations open to the district.
- Presentation: At the annual awards ceremony or Spring Conference.

10.5 Accredited Speaker Program

District 201 shall actively support the Toastmasters International Accredited Speaker (AS) Program. The AS designation recognizes members who have demonstrated professional-level public speaking ability. The district shall publicize the program, recognize AS-designated members at district conferences, and support members preparing for AS applications by facilitating practice opportunities at district events where feasible.

10.6 Club Ambassador Program

District 201 may establish a Club Ambassador Program (CAP) to encourage members to visit clubs outside their home club — growing personally, bringing best practices back to their home clubs, and building a pipeline of future district leaders. The Program Quality Director shall oversee any such program in coordination with the Club Growth Director. Participation criteria and recognition shall be published on the district website.

11. COMMUNICATIONS AND PUBLICATIONS

10.1 District Website

The district shall maintain a website (https://d201tm.org) where information important to members and the public is displayed. This includes district-sponsored events, the current Operating Procedures Manual, Hall of Fame, and other district resources.

10.2 District Newsletter / E-Newsletter

The district shall provide regular electronic communications to promote club events, district news, and information relevant to club members and district officers. Newsletters shall not be used by clubs or individual members for personal business promotions or to give any competitive advantage to contestants.

10.3 Social Media

The District Director may appoint members to serve on a Social Media and Internet Committee, working in conjunction with the Public Relations Manager. Recommended roles include Webmaster, Social Media Manager, Photographer, and Videographer. Social media outlets shall include, but are not limited to: district website, email accounts, Facebook, LinkedIn, Instagram, YouTube, and other relevant platforms.

10.4 District Directory

The District Directory shall contain the name and contact information of all members of the Executive Committee and shall be posted on the district website. All member lists are considered confidential, for internal use by district officers and for official Toastmasters business only.

10.5 Copyright Compliance

The district shall respect and adhere to Toastmasters International copyright guidelines in all publications and communications.

12. RECORD KEEPING AND LEADERSHIP TRANSITION

11.1 District Records

All requests for district records shall be submitted to the District Director. The Immediate Past District Director is responsible for collecting records from their administration. Records shall be submitted to the District Historian or Administrative Manager by December 31 of the following fiscal year.

Records to be kept include:

- Informative correspondence with TI concerning district operations (District Director)
- Procedures/Operations Manual (District Director)
- District contest winners (Program Quality Director)
- District performance records submitted to TI (Program Quality Director)
- Minutes of Council, Executive, Staff, and Standing Committee meetings (Administration Manager)
- Finance Manager's reports (Finance Manager)
- District audit reports (Audit Committee Chair)
- Conference flyers, registration forms, programs, and staff rosters (Conference Chair)

11.2 District Hall of Fame

The Hall of Fame shall be maintained on the district website and shall include:

- Yearly award recipients (Toastmaster of the Year, Division Director of the Year, Area Director of the Year, etc.)
- Past District Directors

11.3 Leadership Transition

11.3.1 Incoming District Director Responsibilities

- Purchase a past district director pin, a district director plaque from TI, and a gift from the outgoing leadership team for the outgoing district director.
- Obtain area and division director packets from TI for training.
- Work with incoming PQD and CGD to train division directors prior to the change-over meeting.
- Provide TI with area alignment, district roster, district financial information, and District Success Plan.

11.3.2 Outgoing District Director Responsibilities

- Purchase an engraved gavel and stand from TI for the incoming district director.
- Purchase gifts for the outgoing district leadership team.
- If the district is distinguished or better, purchase a banner for the change-over meeting and TI Convention.
- Communicate election results to Toastmasters International.

- Ensure financial and district records are transitioned to the incoming finance and administration managers.
- Ensure signature cards are updated.
- Ensure year-end audit is completed and submitted to TI before August 31.
- Prepare for the "Of the Year" Awards program at the fall conference.
- Preside over the alignment, procedures, and nominating committees.

11.3.3 Immediate Past District Director Responsibilities

- Discharges the outgoing district team, whose term ends at midnight June 30.
- Installs incoming area directors, division directors, administration manager, public relations manager, and finance manager.
- Installs incoming district director, program quality director, and club growth director.
- Officiates the exchange of pins ceremony.
- Presents plaque and past district director pin to outgoing district director.

13. CONFLICTS OF INTEREST

The district shall comply with Toastmasters International policies regarding conflicts of interest. Any district officer or committee member with a direct or indirect financial interest in a matter before the DEC or District Council shall disclose that interest and recuse themselves from voting on the matter.

The district shall also comply with TI policies regarding expenses for International Speech contestants participating at the semifinal level at the TI Convention.

14. AMENDMENTS

Any amendments to these Operating Procedures shall follow the process below:

5. Proposed amendments are submitted to the Operations Committee for review.
6. If notice of the amendment is provided to the Council by email at least 14 days prior to the council meeting, adoption requires a simple majority vote.
7. If no prior notice has been given, adoption requires a three-fourths majority of voting members present.
8. The District Director may perform purely editorial changes (spelling, grammar, capitalization, typographic errors) without a council vote; such changes must be logged in the Change Record.
9. All adopted amendments shall be identified by revision date and authority, and published to the district website.

All amendments must comply with Toastmasters International governing documents. Operating procedures may not duplicate, contradict, or be more restrictive than TI governing documents.

APPENDICES

Appendix A: Proxy / Credential Form Template

DISTRICT 201 TOASTMASTERS

District Council Meeting — Proxy Form

I, _____, serving as [ ] President [ ] Vice President Education

of Club # _____, Club Name _____, District 201,

do hereby authorize _____, a member in good standing,

to represent me in all actions at the district council meeting on _____ at _____.

Signed: _____ Date: _____

Printed Name of Proxy Holder: _____

Appendix B: Award Recipients Record

The following table shall be updated annually by the Administration Manager to maintain a comprehensive record of all award recipients.

Year	Award	Recipient
2025-2026	District Toastmaster of the Year	
2025-2026	Club President of the Year	
2025-2026	Club VP Education of the Year	
2025-2026	Area Director of the Year	
2025-2026	Division Director of the Year	
2025-2026	Inspirational Club of the Year	
2025-2026	Phoenix Club of the Year	
2025-2026	District Director's Award	
2025-2026	Communication & Leadership Award	
2025-2026	International Speech Contest Winner	
2025-2026	Evaluation Contest Winner	

Year	Award	Recipient
2025-2026	Humorous Speech Contest Winner	
2025-2026	Table Topics Contest Winner	

Appendix C: Past District 201 Directors

Year	Name	Achievement
2025-2026	*(Inaugural Director — To Be Elected)*	

Appendix D: Change Record

Revision Date	Section	Revised By	Description of Change
March 11, 2026	All	Daisy Lee	Initial Operation Manuel draft
July 1, 2026		Operations Committee	Inaugural edition, District 201 formed.

This appendix draws on publicly available practices from three established Toastmasters districts — District 1 (district1toastmasters.org), District 52 (district52.org), and District 100 (d100tm.org) — and translates them into concrete recommendations for District 201. Each section is organized around a functional area of district operations. The right-hand column states what District 201 should do; the middle column shows the peer-district evidence behind the recommendation.

E.1 Tech & Websites

A district website is the primary public face of the district and the central resource hub for members, club officers, and prospective members. The practices below reflect what each peer district currently makes available online.

Topic	What Peer Districts Do (D1 | D52 | D100)	Recommendation for District 201
Public district website	All three districts maintain a public website with district information, events, and resources (D1: district1toastmasters.org; D52: district52.org; D100: d100tm.org).	Launch and maintain www.district201.org as the primary public resource. Ensure it is mobile-friendly and updated within 14 days of any material change.
Operating Manual online	D100 publishes its Operating Manual as a downloadable PDF directly from its website nav.	Post the current District 201 Operating Procedures Manual as a downloadable PDF on the website at all times, per Section 1.5.
Club directory	D100 publishes a searchable club directory listing meeting type (online/hybrid/in-person), days, times, and contact info. D52 links to the TI Find-a-Club tool.	Maintain a district-specific club directory page on the website with meeting type, schedule, and contact info, supplementing the TI Find-a-Club link.
Live performance dashboards	D100 publishes live dashboards for district performance, club performance, clubs eligible for coaches, Club Success Plan submissions, and October renewals.	Build and publish dashboards for at minimum: (1) club officer training completion, (2) DCP standings, and (3) Club Success Plan submissions. Update at least monthly.
Member Hub / Leader resources	D100 provides a Member Hub with officer tools. D52 maintains a Tools for Leaders page (New Club Kit, Area Visit Report Form 1471, Pathways quick-start sheets). D1 provides a downloadable New Member Docs package.	Create a password-protected (or openly accessible) Leader Resources section with: New Club Kit, Area Director Club Visit Report (TI Form 1471), Pathways quick-start guide, contest documents, and proxy/credential form template.
On-demand training library	D100 offers on-demand club officer training modules online and a role-specific YouTube training playlist. D1 maintains a Training Videos page. D52 offers webinars and live workshops.	Publish on-demand training videos for all seven club officer roles on the district website and/or YouTube channel. Link from the website. Supplement — do not replace — live TLI sessions.
Brand manual	D1 publishes a full Brand Manual (logos, color palette, fonts, graphics, photography) and a Branding Presentation from TLI.	Publish a District 201 Brand Manual on the website defining approved logos, colors, and templates for club and district communications. Make it freely downloadable.
Virtual meeting resources	D1 maintains a dedicated Virtual Meetings resource page covering hybrid and online club formats.	Provide guidance on virtual and hybrid meeting formats on the district website, given District 201's allowance of fully remote district leaders (Section 2.6).
Website usage policy	All three districts state explicitly that website content is for Toastmasters business only and may not be used for solicitation.	Display the standard TI website usage notice on the district website footer and in the district directory.

E.2 Finance & Assets

Refer to Section 7 for the core financial controls and authorization matrix. The following practices supplement those requirements.

Topic	What Peer Districts Do (D1 | D52 | D100)	Recommendation for District 201
Budget transparency	D100 publishes its Operating Manual (which includes financial procedures) publicly. D1 posts its incentive programs with stated award values.	Publish the approved district budget summary on the member-facing section of the district website each fall after DEC approval (Section 7.1). This builds trust and reduces financial disputes.
Incentive program scoping	D1 explicitly bounds incentive reward values (e.g., $100 TI Gift Certificate for July Challenge, $50 for 100% at TLI, $25 for Club Success Plan submission) in published program descriptions.	State specific award values for every incentive in the annual published program guide. Set a total annual incentive budget cap approved by the DEC at the start of each year.
Ongoing award winners record	D1 maintains a Hall of Fame with past-recipient tables for every named award. D52 and D100 maintain similar records online.	Maintain a cumulative award-winners record (Appendix B) updated within 30 days of each conference. This is the authoritative source for Hall of Fame and historical records.
Physical assets register	All districts manage physical property (trophies, banners, equipment) through their Logistics function.	The Logistics Manager (Section 3.7.6) should maintain a written inventory of all district physical assets, updated annually at leadership transition.

E.3 District Operations & Suggested Committees

Section 4 defines the standing committee structure. The following addition is recommended based on common practice among well-established districts.

Director's Advisory Committee (Recommended Addition)

Element	Detail	Rationale
Purpose	A confidential monthly forum for the District Director to work through ideas, opportunities, and challenges with members who have previously served in the role.	New District Directors benefit significantly from access to institutional knowledge. This committee creates a structured, confidential space for that exchange without burdening DEC meetings.
Membership	Past District Governors and Directors in good standing within District 201.	Limits membership to those with direct district-director experience, keeping discussions focused and relevant.
Chairperson	Selected by the current District Director. The Chair sets the monthly agenda and runs the meeting.	Keeps the committee responsive to the current Director's needs while relieving the Director of administrative overhead.
Frequency	Monthly, for approximately 60 minutes.	Regular cadence builds rapport and allows timely input on emerging issues throughout the year.
Authority	Advisory only. All decisions remain with the District Director and DEC.	Prevents confusion about governance authority while capturing the value of experienced counsel.

District Alignment Page (Recommended)

D1 maintains a public District Alignment Page showing current club-to-area and area-to-division assignments. District 201 should publish a current alignment page on its website, updated immediately after each spring council alignment vote (Section 4.3), so clubs and members can always identify their Area and Division Director.

E.4 PR & Communications

Refer to Section 11 for core communications policy. The following practices are drawn directly from what peer districts currently do.

Topic	What Peer Districts Do (D1 | D52 | D100)	Recommendation for District 201
Social media platforms	D1: Facebook, Twitter/X, Instagram, YouTube. D52: Facebook, LinkedIn, Twitter/X. D100: Facebook and newsletter. All maintain active multi-platform presences.	Establish and actively maintain accounts on at minimum Facebook, Instagram, and LinkedIn. Designate platform owners in the Social Media and Internet Committee (Section 11.3). Post at least twice per month per active platform.
Newsletter / e-newsletter	D1 publishes newsletters and maintains a newsletter archive online. D100 publishes a quarterly district magazine and maintains a newsletter archive. D52 offers a mailing list subscription.	Publish a district e-newsletter at least quarterly. Archive all editions on the website. Provide a subscribe link on the website home page. Do not use the newsletter for personal or club business promotions (Section 11.2).
District blog	D1 maintains an active District Blog featuring member stories, event recaps, and leadership updates.	Consider a district blog or news section on the website as a low-cost, high-value engagement tool. Alternatively, the “Share Your Journey” format used by D100 (member-submitted stories) achieves a similar result.
Brand consistency	D1 publishes a Brand Manual and a TLI Branding Presentation to ensure clubs and officers use approved logos, colors, and fonts in all communications.	Publish a District 201 Brand Manual (see Section E.1). Brief all incoming officers on branding standards at TLI. The Webmaster (Section 3.7.7) and PRM (Section 3.7.3) jointly own brand compliance.
Public Relations page	D1 maintains a dedicated Public Relations resources page for clubs and officers.	Create a PR resources page on the district website with approved talking points about Toastmasters, press release templates, social media image guidelines, and contact details for media inquiries.
Event calendar	D1 and D100 both maintain publicly accessible event calendars listing club meetings, district events, speech contests, and training sessions.	Maintain a public district event calendar on the website, updated in real time. Allow clubs to submit their events. This supports the communications mission (Section 11.1) and increases event attendance.

E.5 Recognition, Promotions & Incentives

Refer to Sections 9 and 10 for the awards and incentive framework. The practices below reflect what peer districts currently run and translate into specific recommendations.

Program Design Principles

Principle	Peer District Evidence	District 201 Recommendation
Keep the program focused	D1 runs a defined set of named incentives (July Challenge, 100% Officers Trained, Club Success Plan, Smedley,	Limit active incentive programs to no more than six concurrent offerings per term. Fewer, well-

Principle	Peer District Evidence	District 201 Recommendation
	Talk Up TM) rather than an open-ended list.	promoted incentives drive more participation than a long list that members cannot track.
Align to the annual theme	D100 uses consistent branding across its named programs (Thrive with Five, Ten to Win, Masters of Pathways).	Give each incentive a memorable name that aligns with the district's annual theme. Announce all incentives at the first DEC meeting and publish them on the website by August 1.
Publish progress publicly	D100 publishes live participation dashboards for each named incentive so clubs and leaders can see their standing in real time.	Publish an incentive progress tracker on the district website (or link to TI's dashboards.toastmasters.org). Update at least monthly.
Maintain a winner's record	D1 maintains a detailed awards table online for every incentive and award, updated each year. D52 and D100 maintain similar Hall of Fame records.	Keep a cumulative, annually updated list of all award and incentive recipients (Appendix B, Section 9.9). Post on the district website and update within 30 days of each conference.

TI Membership Building Campaigns — Adopt as District Incentives

District 1 explicitly supports all three TI membership campaigns as part of its incentive program. District 201 should do the same, layering additional district recognition on top of the TI ribbon to amplify participation.

Campaign	TI Eligibility Window & Criteria	District 201 Action
Smedley Award	Add 5 new, dual, or reinstated members between August 1–September 30. Club receives a Smedley Award ribbon and a 10% discount code on their next TI club order.	Promote actively at the fall TLI and in the August e-newsletter. Layer a district ribbon or certificate on top of the TI award for qualifying clubs. Feature winners in the district newsletter.
Talk Up Toastmasters	Add 5 new, dual, or reinstated members between February 1–March 31. Club receives a Talk Up Toastmasters ribbon and a 10% discount code.	Promote at spring TLI and in the January e-newsletter. Layer a district incentive on top. Use Area Directors to personally notify clubs approaching the five-member threshold.
Beat the Clock	Add 5 new, dual, or reinstated members between May 1–June 30. Club receives a Beat the Clock ribbon and a 10% discount code.	Promote in the April e-newsletter and at the spring conference. This campaign bridges the end of the fiscal year and helps clubs achieve membership-based DCP goals before June 30.

Incentives for Leaders (Not Just Clubs)

Peer districts focus most incentives at the club level. District 201 should additionally recognize Area Directors and Division Directors who achieve performance milestones, reinforcing the leadership pipeline.

Award	Eligibility Criterion	Recognition
100% Club Visits — Area Director	Area Director completes all required club visits on time and submits reports by TI deadlines in both semiannual periods.	Certificate of achievement presented at fall and spring conference. Listed in newsletter and on website.
100% Club Success Plans — Area Director	All clubs in the area submit a signed Club Success Plan by August 31.	District ribbon and website recognition. Announced at fall conference.

Award	Eligibility Criterion	Recognition
Distinguished Division Director	Division achieves Distinguished or better status by June 1.	Named recognition at spring conference. Listed in Hall of Fame record.

E.6 District Events

Refer to Section 7.6 for financial requirements for district events. The following practices are drawn from peer districts.

Topic	What Peer Districts Do (D1 | D52 | D100)	Recommendation for District 201
Public event calendar	D1 and D100 both publish rich, searchable public event calendars listing club meetings, speech contests, training sessions, and district events. D1 allows clubs to add their own events.	Publish and maintain a public district event calendar on the website from Day 1. Allow clubs and officers to submit events. This is one of the highest-traffic pages on peer district websites.
Spring conference	All three peer districts hold a spring conference coinciding with the annual council meeting and speech contests.	Plan the spring conference as a multi-session event combining the annual District Council meeting, spring speech contests (International and Evaluation), TLI, and an awards ceremony. Budget and venue should be confirmed no later than January 1.
Speakers' Bureau regular meetings	D100's Speakers' Bureau meets monthly (first Saturday, except holiday months) in hybrid format — in-person at Caltech, Pasadena, plus Zoom. Registration is open online.	Establish a regular monthly Speakers' Bureau meeting schedule with a consistent hybrid format (in-person venue + Zoom) so speakers and audience members can attend regardless of location (Section 4.10).
Learning Lab / supplemental education	D100 hosts Learning Labs on the first Sunday and fourth Saturday of each month at 8 AM Pacific via Zoom — a standing supplemental educational event outside the conference cycle.	Consider a monthly or bimonthly Learning Lab (virtual or hybrid) offering skill-building sessions, Pathways project practice, or leadership workshops. This extends educational access beyond twice-annual TLI events.
Speechcraft facilitator workshops	D1 runs Speechcraft Facilitator Workshops as stand-alone events to equip members to run Speechcraft programs in their clubs.	Offer at least one Speechcraft Facilitator Workshop per year (Section 4.9), timed before peak club-recruitment periods (August–September and January–February).
Office hours for leaders	D1 schedules Club Growth Director Office Hours as a recurring public event so clubs and members can get direct guidance.	Schedule regular office hours for the Club Growth Director and Program Quality Director as recurring, publicly posted events. This makes leadership accessible and reduces one-on-one email burden.

E.7 Training

Refer to Section 4.6 for core training requirements and Section 10.2.1 for training incentives. The following supplements those standards with peer-district best practices.

Topic	What Peer Districts Do (D1 | D52 | D100)	Recommendation for District 201
Semiannual TLI (live)	All three districts run live TLI sessions in both semiannual periods. D1 and D52 offer in-person and virtual makeup sessions. D100 tracks completion with a public dashboard.	Hold two live TLI sessions per year (July–August and January–February). Provide at least one makeup session per round. Publish training completion rates publicly on the district website dashboard.

Topic	What Peer Districts Do (D1 | D52 | D100)	Recommendation for District 201
On-demand / video training	D100 offers on-demand club officer training modules online. D1 maintains a Training Videos page. D100 publishes role-specific officer training as a YouTube playlist.	Record training content for all seven club officer roles and host on the district website and YouTube channel. Link prominently from the website. On-demand content is especially valuable for District 201 given its remote-leader provisions (Section 2.6).
Club officer makeup training	D1 offers scheduled Club Officer Makeup Training sessions throughout the year so officers who missed TLI can still earn credit.	Schedule at least two makeup training sessions per semiannual period at varied times (morning and evening) to maximize accessibility. Publicize dates on the event calendar.
Pathways support	D52 designates a named Pathways Chair as the member contact for Pathways questions (pathways@district52.org). D52's PQD serves as the DTM resource (pqd@district52.org). D1 offers "Pathways with Power" as a standing educational series.	Designate a Pathways Chair (appointed by the PQD) and publish their contact on the website. Run a recurring "Pathways with Power" style educational event (webinar or club visit series) to drive Pathways enrollment and completion.
Path to DTM guidance	D1 maintains a dedicated "Path to DTM" resource page explaining each step from club officer to DTM.	Publish a clear "Path to DTM" guide on the district website. Feature it prominently in the Educational Programs section and in new-member onboarding communications.

E.8 District History & Hall of Fame

Refer to Sections 10.3, 11.2, and 12.2 for core Hall of Fame and records requirements. The following details what peer districts currently maintain and what District 201 should build from its inaugural year.

Topic	What Peer Districts Do (D1 | D52 | D100)	Recommendation for District 201
Hall of Fame web page	D1 maintains a comprehensive Hall of Fame page with separate sub-pages for every award category: Toastmaster of the Year, Division Director of the Year, Area Director of the Year, named lifetime awards (Roy D. Graham, Lydia Boyd), Past District Directors, Past DECs, Past International Presidents, Past International Directors, Presidential Citation Recipients, World Champions, and Golden Gavel recipients.	Create a Hall of Fame page on the district website from Year 1 with sub-pages for each award category. Even with no recipients yet, establishing the structure signals permanence and encourages aspiration. Populate immediately after the first spring conference.
Named lifetime awards	D1 has two named lifetime awards with distinct honoree pages and full past-recipient lists: the Roy D. Graham Lifetime Achievement Award and the Lydia Boyd Leadership Legacy Award — which correspond directly to District 201's Lifetime Achievement Award and Leadership Legacy Award (Sections 10.4.1 and 10.4.2).	Create dedicated web pages for the Lifetime Achievement Award and Leadership Legacy Award, including eligibility criteria, selection process, and past recipients. Update immediately after each spring conference presentation.
Past District Directors page	D1 and D100 both maintain a standalone Past District Directors page. D1 also lists past DECs.	Maintain Appendix C (Past District 201 Directors) both in this manual and as a dedicated website page. From the inaugural year, record the Director's name, term, and achievement level

Topic	What Peer Districts Do (D1 | D52 | D100)	Recommendation for District 201
		(Distinguished or better). Add past DECs as the district matures.
Presidential Citation & World Champions	D1 lists all Presidential Citation recipients and all World Champions of Public Speaking from the district as distinct Hall of Fame categories.	Add Presidential Citation and World Champion categories to the Hall of Fame from Year 1. These are rare and prestigious designations; recording them establishes the district's long-term legacy infrastructure.
Cumulative award winners record	D1 maintains a detailed, annually updated award winners table for every incentive and recognition program on its website.	Update Appendix B (Award Recipients Record) within 30 days of every conference. The Administration Manager owns this record (Section 3.7.1). Publish a version on the district website in the Hall of Fame section.
Historian continuity	All peer districts manage historian functions to preserve institutional memory, including club charters, contest results, and leadership records.	The Historian (Section 4.11) serves a three-month overlap with the incoming historian (July 1–September 30 of the following year). Include this overlap in the leadership transition checklist (Section 12.3) and confirm it at the spring council meeting.

E.9 Source Notes

All information in this appendix was compiled from publicly available content on the district websites listed below, accessed in March 2026. All Toastmasters International trademarks, logos, and copyrights are the sole property of Toastmasters International and are used by permission. District 201 should verify current practices directly with each district or with Toastmasters International as needed.

District	Website	Key Pages Referenced
District 1	district1toastmasters.org	Awards & Recognition, Hall of Fame, Brand Manual, Resources, Events Calendar, Pathways with Power, Training Videos, Club Growth, Public Relations
District 52	district52.org	Leadership 2025–2026, Educational Programs, Tools for Leaders
District 100	d100tm.org	About, Dashboards, Incentives (Thrive with Five / Ten to Win / Masters of Pathways), Speakers' Bureau, Learning Lab, On-Demand Training, Quarterly Magazines, Share Your Journey
Toastmasters International	toastmasters.org	TI Membership Campaigns (Smedley, Talk Up TM, Beat the Clock), Find-a-Club, TI Speech Contest Rulebook, dashboards.toastmasters.org